

The text of an **opera** or other vocal dramatic work.

Lied (pl. Lieder)

A traditional German song, popularized by Schubert.

madrigal

A secular **a cappella** song popular in Renaissance and early **Baroque** England and Italy; it was often set to a love poem.

Mass

The main service of the Roman Catholic Church, highly formalized in structure, comprising specific sections—known as the “Ordinary”—performed in the following order: Kyrie, Gloria, Credo, Sanctus with Hosanna and Benedictus, and Agnus Dei with Dona nobis pacem.

mezzo-soprano

Literally “half soprano”; the lowest **soprano** voice; between soprano and **contralto**.

Minimalism

A predominantly American school of music, favoring a sound-world involving an almost hypnotic texture of repeated short patterns.

mode

A type of seven-note **scale** with distinct melodic